WHAT IS SAFESPORT?

The U.S. Center for SafeSport ("Center") is a nonprofit committed to building a sport community free of emotional, physical, sexual abuse, and misconduct. It is independent of USA Triathlon and is responsible for setting training requirements and abuse-prevention policies for all Olympic sports in the United States, including triathlon. The Center responds to and resolves allegations of abuse that are reported and enforces any sanctions that arise from investigations of misconduct.

History of SafeSport

2010

After allegations of sexual abuse in amateur sport, Congress declares the need for an organization dedicated to ending abuse. The U.S. Center for SafeSport was created

2018

The Protecting Young Victims from Sexual Abuse and SafeSport Authorization Act of 2017 is passed by Congress providing the U.S. Center for SafeSport with the scope and authority to resolve abuse and misconduct throughout the U.S. Olympic and Paralympic Movement

2024

In January 2024, USA Triathlon launches new policies for events with minors. Review this guide for more information on these requirements

All USA Triathlon sanctioned events MUST adhere to SafeSport policies and procedures in order to maintain their sanctioned status. Below are resources to ensure SafeSport compliance at USAT sanctioned events:

- SafeSport Code for the U.S. Olympic and Paralympic Movement: Defines the Center's authority and jurisdiction, prohibited categories of abuse and misconduct, and the Center's process for responding to and resolving abuse and misconduct claims affecting the U.S. Olympic and Paralympic Movement.

- Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies (MAAPP): A collection of proactive prevention and training policies with three primary components: an Education and Training Policy, Required Prevention Policies, and Recommended Prevention Policies. Check out at At-A-Glance View of the MAAPP.

- Quality Control System for Event Directors: Outlines USA Triathlon's protocol to ensure that event directors hosting USAT sanctioned events meet SafeSport policies.

- Sanctioned Events with Youth Participants: Directive for event directors hosting a USAT sanctioned event involving youth participants (e.g., athletes, volunteers, etc.).

For any questions concerning SafeSport policies and procedures, please contact trisafesupport@usatriathlon.org. Please contact eventtrisafe@usatriathlon.org for questions pertaining to event compliance.

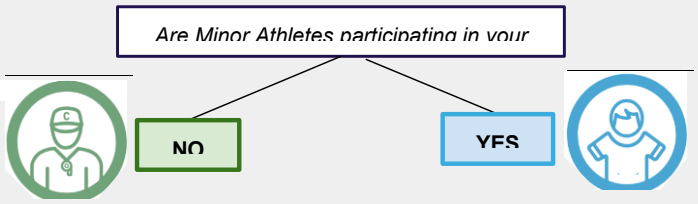
Commented [1]: Note: Will need to be updated in 2025 with addition of fourth component: Organizational Requirements for Education & Training and Prevention Policies

PRIOR TO THE EVENT:

1

STEP 1: DETERMINE YOUR RACE AUDIENCE

MAAPP requirements apply when youth participants, including Minor Athletes, are participating in a USA Triathlon sanctioned event. A Minor Athlete is any amateur athlete under 18 years of age who participates in a race that is under the jurisdiction of USAT, USOPC, or USAT Official Club. As you set out to determine your race audience and age limit policies, bear in mind that these decisions will affect your SafeSport/MAAPP requirements.

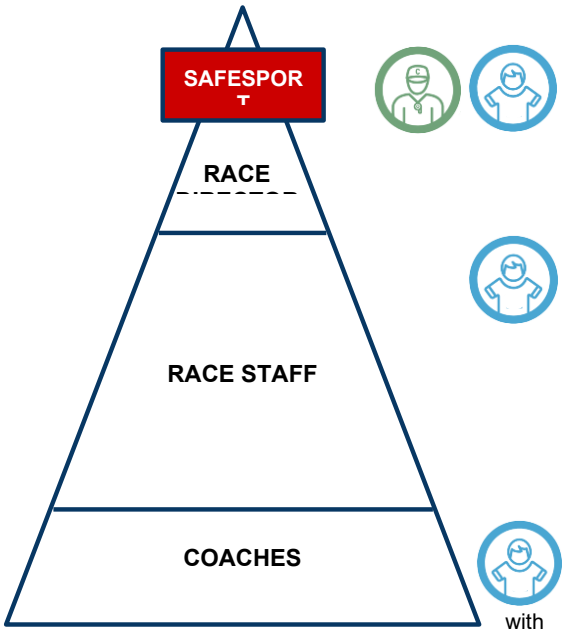


2

STEP 2: SAFESPORT TRAINING

The SafeSport training course is mandated to help the multisport community prevent, recognize, and respond to abuse. There is an initial 90-minute core training that must be completed every four years. For the years in between, a 30 minute refresher course will need to be completed annually to keep the certification up to date. **To finalize the event sanctioning process, a Race Director MUST have a current SafeSport certification and background check on-file with USA Triathlon**. Please complete the SafeSport training at least two weeks prior to the event.

Refer to the diagram on the following page for more information about the SafeSport requirements for the different groups involved in the operations of events that involve adult and/or minor athletes:



Race Director: All Race Directors who apply to host a USA Triathlon sanctioned event will need to complete the SafeSport Trained Core course or Refresher course, as applicable, and a background check. Proof of completion is required to finalize the sanctioning process.

Race Staff: For events with minors, it is required that all staff who will have regular contact and/or authority over minors complete the SafeSport Certification. For example, this list may include (but is not limited to): Check-In Manager, Swim Manager, Bike Manager, Run Manager, Finish Line Manager, Safety Coordinator, Volunteer Coordinator, Race Officials, and Race Announcers. It is the Race Director's responsibility to enforce this requirement.

Coaches: Coaches must be SafeSport trained to qualify as a coach at the event. For events with minors, Race Directors will be responsible for tracking the presence of coaches on-site at their event (See steps below).

VIEW YOUR SAFESPORT STATUS:

All Race Directors who sanction an event with USA Triathlon will have access to the USA Triathlon Membership Hub. Follow these steps to view your SafeSport status.

- On the Menu Sidebar, hover over "*Settings*"
- Click "*SafeSport*"
- If training has already been completed, the list of your completed courses and certification expiration dates will be displayed.
- If training is still required, you will see a banner that reads *"Invalid SafeSport Entry"*. Click *"Renew SafeSport"* and follow the instructions to take your required course(s).

Once complete, save a copy of your completion certificate for your records. Email trisafesupport@usatriathlon.org with any technical difficulties.

3

STEP 3: GATHER COACH INFORMATION

As of January 2024, events with minors need to collect information for all coaches who will be on-site at the event. This process begins during the athlete registration process. **Prior to your event registration launch**, add questions to your online registration that ask for the name, phone number, email address, and date of birth of coaches who will be in attendance.

- **List of All Coaches**: Click here for the template to log all coach information. Please email this list of coach information to USA Triathlon ***two weeks in advance of the event*** to eventtrisafe@usatriathlon.org. Once reviewed, USA Triathlon will provide Race Directors with the SafeSport certification status of all registered coaches.

DID YOU KNOW?

Safesport defines a coach as someone who:

1. Has or shares the responsibility for instructing, teaching, training, or advising an athlete in the context of triathlon and is certified as a USA Triathlon coach.

2. Is identified by a registered athlete of a USAT sanctioned event as a "coach" who is potentially attending a USAT sanction event.

3. Is not a USAT-certified coach but self-identifies as a "coach", who may attend an USAT sanctioned event.

4

STEP 4: COMMUNICATE THE MAAPP

As the Race Director of a USA Triathlon sanctioned event with youth participants, including Minor Athletes, you are required to provide (e.g., email) the Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies (MAAPP) to all individuals who will be participating in any capacity at your event ***no more than 30 days prior to your event and once registration closes*.***

- **MAAPP Communication:** This communication must include the key tenants of the MAAPP, a link to the USA Triathlon SafeSport Policies and References, and an explanation of mandatory reporting requirements. The recipient list for this email should include, but is not limited to the following:

EMAIL RECIPIENTS:		
• Athletes	• Contractors	• Officials
• Announcers	• Credentialed coaches	• Timers

• Camera crew • Staff	• Media personnel • Medical support	• USADA chaperones • Volunteers

**MAAPP communication must be sent to all participating, including athletes and volunteers who may register the day of your event. Include a QR code and/or link within the body of your event confirmation email that directs participants to the policies of the MAAPP. Consider displaying signage at the day-of registration tables and/or insert a printout outlining MAAPP policies within athlete race packets / volunteer guides.*

5

STEP 5: CROSS-CHECK BANNED LISTS

Any individual banned or suspended (even if temporarily) by USAT, the U.S. Center for SafeSport, and/or USADA may not participate in any USA Triathlon sanctioned event in any capacity (including but not limited to any of the roles listed in the list above). It is the Race Director's responsibility to check all participants against the USA Triathlon Sanctioned list and U.S. Center for SafeSport Suspended List prior to the event.

- **USA Triathlon Sanctioned List:** The list of individuals who are ineligible to participate in a USA Triathlon sanctioned event (e.g., permanent ban, suspension, etc.) can be found on the USA Triathlon website.
- **U.S. Center for SafeSport Suspended List:** The list of individuals who have received a temporary restriction (e.g., suspension) from the Center or a National Governing Body (NGB) can be found in the U.S. Center for SafeSport's Centralized Disciplinary Database.

6

STEP 6: LOGISTICS PLANNING FOR COMPLIANCE

The key policy of the MAAPP is that one-on-one contact with minor athletes should be avoided. If one-on-one contact with a minor athlete is required, it must be observable and interruptible.

As you work through your race operations plans, reference the chart below for the compliance considerations for different race areas. For more detailed information for each operational area, please refer directly to the MAAPP.

LOGISTICS PLANNING:		
RACE AUDIENCE	**OPERATIONS**	**COMPLIANCE NOTES**
All Events	**Mandatory Signage**	Click here to view the signage required at your event. This signage provided by USAT and the U.S. Center for SafeSport ensures participants know how and what to report when it comes to misconduct. Take the necessary steps to have this signage printed and installed at the event.
Events with Minors	**Mandatory Coach Check-In**	Events with Minors are required to have an on-site check-in area for coaches at the event. Coaches will need to present their IDs and proof of their SafeSport certification. Names should be checked against the lists of suspended and banned individuals (linked above). Certified coaches should receive a wristband and/or credential so they are easily identifiable. Coaches should have the opportunity to take the training on-site so they can be identified as coaches at the event. Take steps to plan for the following: ● Equipment: Tent, table(s), chair(s) ● Accreditation: Wristbands / credentials ● Staffing Resources
All Events	**Meetings & Training Sessions**	Recommendation: Adults should not have out-of-program contact with Minors without legal/parent guardian consent, even if the out-of-program contact is not one-on-one.
All Events	**Athletic Training Modality Massages & Rubdowns**	Recommendation: Even if a coach or staff member is a licensed massage therapist or certified athletic trainer, they should not perform a rubdown or massage of an athlete under any circumstance.
All Events	**Locker Rooms, Restrooms, & Changing Areas**	Recommendations: 1. Adults should make every effort to recognize when a minor goes to the restroom or changing area. If they do not return in a timely fashion, check on their whereabouts. 2. USA Triathlon discourages parents from entering changing areas unless it is truly necessary. In those instances, it should only be a same-sex parent. If this is necessary, parents should notify a coach or staff person in advance.
All Events	**Social Media & Electronic Communications**	Recommendation: Only platforms that allow for open and transparent communication may be used to communicate with minors.
All Events	**Transportation**	Recommendation: USA Triathlon encourages parents/guardians to pick up their minor first and drop off the minor last in any shared or carpool travel arrangement.
All Events	**Lodging**	Recommendation: USA Triathlon encourages parents/legal guardians to receive

		education concerning child abuse prevention before providing consent for their minor to travel alone with an adult

DURING THE EVENT:

PARTICIPANT CHECK-IN:

At all USA Triathlon sanctioned events, all participants must have photo identification. A minor athlete without a photo ID must be accompanied by a parent/guardian with a photo ID. If an adult participant does not bring a photo ID to packet pick-up 'there are two options: (1) go home to get it or (2) have someone email/text a copy of their photo ID.

Any participant that attempts to register on-site for the event (as opposed to in advance) must be checked against the list of banned and suspended individuals. If a banned or suspended individual attempts to participate in the event, the Race Director must notify the USA Triathlon Legal Department at trisafe@usatriathlon.org **immediately**.

COACH CHECK-IN:

Events with minors need to have a designated area for coach check-in. Coaches will need to present their photo IDs and proof of SafeSport certification (if applicable). A list should be recorded with the names (first & last), phone number, email address, and certification status of all coaches on-site. As a best practice, certified coaches should be provided with a wristband and/or credential so they are easily identifiable throughout the event.

All coaches should also be checked against the list of banned and suspended individuals. If a banned or suspended individual attempts to check in as a coach at the event, the Race Director must notify the USA Triathlon Legal Department at trisafe@usatriathlon.org **immediately.**

SIGNAGE INSTALL:

At all USA Triathlon sanctioned events, follow the Signage Guide for direction on where the MAAPP related signage should be posted on-site at the event. Affix signage in locations that are unobstructed and heavily trafficked.

Pro Tip:
Take photos of the MAAPP related signage that is installed on-site and save in your recap file.

AFTER THE EVENT:

FINAL INFORMATION DUE TO USAT:
Please send along the following information to eventtrisafe@usatriathlon.org within ***two weeks after the event***:

EVENTS WITH ADULTS:
• Final participant list or race results uploaded to the sanctioning site under the tab "Results" (the tab will appear once the event has ended)

EVENTS WITH MINORS:
• Final participant list or race results uploaded to the sanctioning site under the tab "Results" (the tab will appear once the event has ended) • List of any individuals on the banned or suspended list that attempted to register to participate in the event • List of coaches that checked in at the event (both certified and non-certified)

MANDATORY REPORTING:
All adult participants – including those with one-day memberships – at USAT events are Mandatory Reporters. If an individual witnesses any form of abuse – including sexual, physical, or emotional – they must report it to either USA Triathlon or the U.S. Center for SafeSport ***within 24 hours.***

If child abuse is suspected, it must also be reported to law enforcement and the U.S. Center for SafeSport. Child abuse and sexual misconduct will be reported to the agency designated by the State's Attorney General, consistent with federal requirements set forth in section 226 of the Victims of Child Abuse Actof 1990 (34 U.S.C. § 20341).

- How to Report Child Abuse and Neglect
- State Child Abuse and Neglect Reporting Numbers

SAFESPORT AUDITS:

The U.S. Center for SafeSport may periodically conduct audits of randomly selected USA Triathlon sanctioned events. These audits evaluate the effectiveness of the policies and protocols followed prior before, during, and after the event.

If an audit is conducted, USA Triathlon staff will support the Race Director through the process to make the audit as seamless as possible. For any questions concerning SafeSport policies and procedures, please contact trisafesupport@usatriathlon.org. Please contact eventtrisafe@usatriathlon.org for questions pertaining to event compliance.

The information in this Guide is for general information purposes and should be used as a general guide and for general information purposes only. The information in this Guide is not intended to be legal advice or consultant advice. You should consult with experts in the defined area before making any decisions. USAT assumes no responsibility for the accuracy of the information contained in Guide or its suitability for any purpose, and such information is subject to change without notice. USAT makes no representation or warranty, express or implied, regarding the information in this Guide. Your use of the information in this Guide is solely at your own risk. The Guide may also contain links to third-party content, which USAT does not warrant, endorse, or assume liability for the third-party content.